Dear Quillstone Payments Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Machine Learning Engineer – Customer Support AI role. I hold an MSc in Computer Science from the University of Drava and have over five years of experience across machine learning and NLP, including shipping and operating production ML systems, and I am currently pursuing a PhD focused on named entity recognition in Croatian legal texts. I am drawn to the opportunity to build AI systems that help merchants get support quickly and help support teams work more effectively.

In my current role at Slavonica Document AI, I developed and deployed a classifier for scanned public-administration documents that achieves 94% accuracy and a 0.91 macro F1 score across 23 classes, processing approximately 15,000 documents per day. I fine-tuned XLM-R and BERTić models for Croatian document classification and named entity recognition, and serve models through FastAPI and Docker on Azure. I also built production monitoring that helped identify an OCR change associated with a nine-percentage-point accuracy drop, which was resolved within a week. This work has given me hands-on experience taking ML systems from data preparation and experimentation through model serving, production monitoring and model versioning with MLflow.

My earlier work at Baranjska kreditna banka included classifying customer complaints into 11 topics to support weekly reporting for customer-service management. I have also built a weekend prototype for question answering over Croatian laws using retrieval-augmented generation (RAG). This was a personal prototype, not a production system, and it strengthened my interest in language-based tools for finding and using relevant information. Across these projects, I have worked with Python, Azure, MLflow, PyTorch and Hugging Face Transformers, and I value practical, evidence-led iteration.

Quillstone's focus on customer-support automation and its emphasis on team ownership, open sharing of context and learning from mistakes appeal to me. I would welcome the opportunity to bring my production NLP, model-serving and monitoring experience and a pragmatic approach to the AI team and contribute to systems that make support more useful for merchants and agents.

Kind regards,
Petra Zlatarić-Novosel